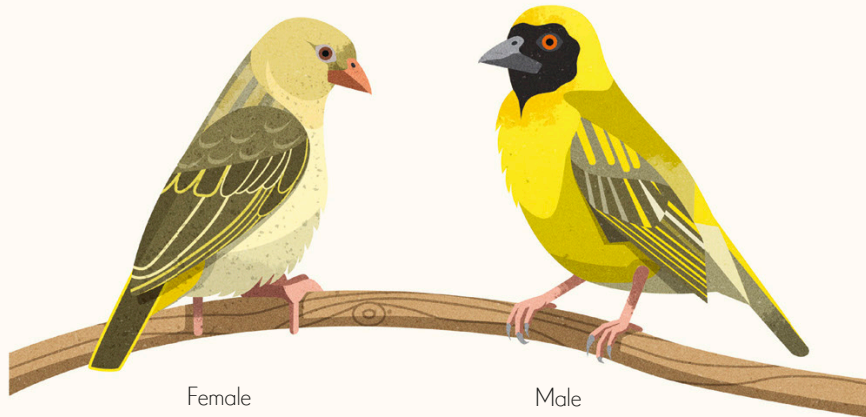


Weaver bird



Meet one of the world's most amazing animal architects. The crafty male weaver bird knows exactly how to stop snakes reaching his nest. He ties a long blade of grass onto a thin branch, twists it into a loop, then weaves more grass around it, in an action like plaiting hair. After five days' work, he's built a woven, snake-proof basket. Very impressive when all you have is a beak and feet to help!

There are many species of weaver bird, all with their own nest design. Sociable weavers live in groups, and share a giant nest of twigs and straw. This weaver village can be 6 m (20 ft) long and be home to 100 families!

*Female weaver birds tug at nests
to test which are strongest.
Flimsy ones won't get used.*